

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12409737
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Glöckner; Rico et al.

Output speed monitoring for an electric drive train

Abstract

A method for monitoring an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine, including inputting an actual value for a longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine and inputting an actual value for the output speed. The method further includes establishing a characteristic curve of a limit value for the output speed as a function of the longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine and verifying whether, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. The method further includes outputting a control signal for bringing about an operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain according to a verification result based on the verification step.

Inventors:	Glöckner; Rico (Pocking, DE), Bebeti; Migen (Munich, DE)
Applicant:	ZF FRIEDRICHSHAFEN AG (Friedrichshafen, DE)
Family ID:	85278344
Assignee:	ZF FRIEDRICHSHAFEN AG (Friedrichshafen, DE)
Appl. No.:	18/838264
Filed (or PCT Filed):	February 14, 2023
PCT No.:	PCT/EP2023/053617
PCT Pub. No.:	WO2023/156379
PCT Pub. Date:	August 24, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250145012 A1	May. 08, 2025

Foreign Application Priority Data

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **B60L15/10** (20060101); **B60L15/20** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **B60L15/10** (20130101); **B60L15/20** (20130101); B60L2200/40 (20130101);
B60L2240/16 (20130101); B60L2240/421 (20130101); B60L2250/26 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: B60L (15/10); B60L (15/20); B60L (2200/40); B60L (2240/16); B60L (2240/421); B60L (2250/26)

USPC: 701/22

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
4107776	12/1977	Beale	701/99	B60W 30/1819
4354568	12/1981	Griesenbrock	180/274	B60K 31/0075
4414863	12/1982	Heino	477/65	F16H 61/0213
5126942	12/1991	Matsuda	701/76	B60K 23/0808
5323667	12/1993	Tweed	477/122	F02D 31/007
5389051	12/1994	Hirate	477/107	F02D 31/006
6223111	12/2000	Cronin	477/68	F16H 61/46
6546329	12/2002	Bellinger	123/480	B60W 30/1819
6629026	12/2002	Baraszu	701/67	B60K 6/48
6814053	12/2003	Hawkins	123/192.1	F02D 31/001
7190134	12/2006	Shibata	318/400.23	H02P 29/50
8579759	12/2012	Akebono	477/6	B60W 30/186
9976641	12/2017	Caldwell	N/A	F04B 11/00
10036359	12/2017	Hao	N/A	B60K 6/48
11752878	12/2022	Kim	701/22	B60K 1/02
11970154	12/2023	Yang	N/A	B60L 3/102
2003/0216847	12/2002	Bellinger	701/72	F16H 61/66
2005/0234622	12/2004	Pillar	701/41	G08G 1/20
2007/0192012	12/2006	Letang	180/170	B60W 30/146
2009/0042688	12/2008	Itou	477/3	H02P 6/08
2009/0187316	12/2008	Romine	701/51	B60K 17/28
2010/0025131	12/2009	Gloceri	180/65.265	B60K 6/52
2011/0082630	12/2010	Kawaguchi	477/34	F16H 61/0031
2011/0112708	12/2010	Fassnacht	180/65.265	B60W 10/08
2012/0108387	12/2011	Akebono	477/12	B60W 30/186
2012/0109478	12/2011	Mochiyama	701/68	B60W 30/186
2012/0209464	12/2011	Falkenstein	903/902	B60W 40/1005

2013/0090835	12/2012	Takeuchi	701/103	F02D 31/007
2013/0166121	12/2012	Takeuchi	701/1	B60W 10/08
2014/0046561	12/2013	Oohata	701/65	F16H 61/2807
2014/0277985	12/2013	Zent	701/83	B60T 8/175
2014/0288776	12/2013	Anderson	701/37	F16F 9/064
2015/0105950	12/2014	Fleege	701/22	B60L 15/2054
2015/0183427	12/2014	Kuras	701/41	B60W 30/02
2015/0224845	12/2014	Anderson	701/37	B60G 17/052
2015/0237797	12/2014	Bejcek	56/10.8	A01D 34/006
2015/0259880	12/2014	Sharma	701/43	E02F 9/2025
2015/0259883	12/2014	Sharma	701/41	E02F 9/0841
2016/0121924	12/2015	Norstad	701/41	B62D 5/0481
2016/0208898	12/2015	Caldwell	N/A	F04B 11/0075
2016/0288781	12/2015	Shim	N/A	B60K 6/48
2023/0157203	12/2022	Revelli	56/10.2 A	A01D 34/008

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
4427697	12/1994	DE	N/A
102018131964	12/2019	DE	N/A
102019220357	12/2020	DE	N/A
102020201497	12/2020	DE	N/A

Primary Examiner: Martinez Borrero; Luis A

Attorney, Agent or Firm: LEYDIG, VOIT & MAYER, LTD.

Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a U.S. National Phase application under 35 U.S.C. § 371 of International Application No. PCT/EP2023/053617, filed on Feb. 14, 2023, and claims benefit to German Patent Application No. DE 10 2022 201 604.1, filed on Feb. 16, 2022. The International Application was published in German on Aug. 24, 2023 as WO 2023/156379 A1 under PCT Article 21 (2).

FIELD

(2) The present invention relates to a method and to a control device for monitoring an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine, and to a self-propelled work machine comprising an electric drivetrain and a control device of that kind.

BACKGROUND

(3) It is known from the prior art to limit controlled variables for actuating an electric motor in order to ensure the electric motor is operated safely. For this purpose, a maximum controlled variable can be predefined in relation to an operating parameter of the electric motor.

(4) To monitor an output speed resulting from such controlled variables, however, limiting controlled variables in an electric drivetrain may not be sufficient to avoid safety-relevant divergences in the output speed in the electric drivetrain.

SUMMARY

(5) In an embodiment, the present disclosure provides a method for monitoring an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine, comprising inputting an actual value for a longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine and inputting an actual value for the output

speed. The method further comprises establishing a characteristic curve of a limit value for the output speed as a function of the longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine and verifying whether, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. The method further comprises outputting a control signal for bringing about an operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain according to a verification result based on the verification step.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) Subject matter of the present disclosure will be described in even greater detail below based on the exemplary figures. All features described and/or illustrated herein can be used alone or combined in different combinations. The features and advantages of various embodiments will become apparent by reading the following detailed description with reference to the attached drawings, which illustrate the following:

(2) FIG. 1 schematically illustrates a self-propelled work machine and a control device according to an embodiment of the invention; and

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates a flowchart comprising method steps for carrying out a method for monitoring an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(4) In an aspect, the present disclosure relates to a method for monitoring an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine.

(5) As one step, the method comprises inputting an actual value for a longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine. The self-propelled work machine can be a construction machine or an agricultural work machine, for example. According to an embodiment, the self-propelled work machine is a wheeled loader. The method for monitoring the output speed can be carried out in order to operate the electric drivetrain in an operationally safe state in which an undesirable output speed can be avoided. The output speed of the electric drivetrain can be an output speed of an electric motor, a transmission, or a wheel in the electric drivetrain.

(6) The longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine can have an angle between a longitudinal axis of the self-propelled work machine and a horizontal. The longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine can be set on the basis of a tilt of the ground on which the self-propelled work machine is found. The longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine can also be set on the basis of an orientation of the longitudinal axis in relation to the ground.

(7) As a further step, the method can comprise acquiring the actual value for the longitudinal tilt using a sensor. Alternatively or additionally, as a further step the method can comprise reading out the actual value from a geographic information system. The sensor can be a tilt sensor which can be arranged on the self-propelled work machine. Alternatively or additionally, the sensor can be a position acquisition sensor, for example a GNSS sensor. Furthermore, the sensor can be an acceleration sensor or a gyroscope. The sensor can also be at least one oil level sensor, preferably two oil level sensor units, which can operate according to the principle of a hydrostatic level on the self-propelled work machine. According to an embodiment, the longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine can be read out from the geographic information system on the basis of a position acquired using the position sensor.

(8) As a further step, the method comprises inputting an actual value for the output speed. According to an embodiment, the output speed can be read out from the inverter of the electric drivetrain; the read-out output speed can be the actual speed of the electric motor. As a further step, the method can comprise acquiring the actual value using a speed sensor. At least one of the aforementioned components of the electric drivetrain can comprise the speed sensor. The actual

value can be read out from the speed sensor either directly or indirectly. The speed sensor can be configured to tap the actual value from at least one of the aforementioned components of the electric drivetrain.

(9) As a further step, the method comprises establishing a characteristic curve of a limit value for the output speed as a function of the longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine. The characteristic curve can be stored in software of one of the aforementioned controllers. The characteristic curve can define a maximum value for the output speed as a function of the longitudinal tilt. The limit value for the output speed can be a limit value of an output speed gradient or of an acceleration. The limit value of the output speed gradient can have at least one out of a negative output speed gradient and a positive output speed gradient. The characteristic curve can thus act to limit the output speed. The limit value for the output speed can also be a limit value of a gradient of the output speed gradient or of a jerk. The limit value of the gradient of the output speed gradient can have at least one out of a negative gradient of the output speed gradient and a positive gradient of the output speed gradient. Thus, the limit value for the output speed can be established as a function of the longitudinal tilt. According to an embodiment, when the longitudinal tilt is a downward grade, a higher limit value can be established in accordance with the previous embodiment than when the longitudinal tilt is an upward grade.

(10) As a further step, the method comprises verifying whether, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. Alternatively or additionally, the verification step can be carried out according to the determined target value for the torque. A verification result based on the verification step can be that the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt exceeds the predetermined longitudinal tilt limit value. A further verification result based on the verification step can be that the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt does not exceed the predetermined limit value for the longitudinal tilt. In the verification step, therefore, an erroneous or undesirable actual value for the output speed can be detected. An erroneous or critical speed, or an erroneous or critical torque, can thus be prevented.

(11) According to an embodiment, as a further step the method can comprise verifying whether, according to the determined target value for the torque, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. A verification result based on the verification step can be that, according to the determined target value for the torque, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. A further verification result based on the verification step can be that, according to the determined target value for the torque, the input actual value for the output speed does not exceed the limit value established in the characteristic curve.

(12) As a further step, the method comprises outputting a control signal for bringing about an operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain according to a verification result based on the verification step. The control signal can be output if a verification result based on the verification step shows that, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. According to an embodiment, the step of outputting the control signal is not carried out if a verification result based on the verification step shows that, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt does not exceed the limit value established in the characteristic curve. In the step of outputting the control signal, said control signal can be output to at least one of the aforementioned components of the electric drivetrain in order to actuate them and bring about the operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain.

(13) According to an embodiment of the method, the control signal can be output if a verification result based on the verification step shows that, according to the determined target value for the torque, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. According to an embodiment, the step of outputting the control signal is not

carried out if a verification result based on the verification step shows that, according to the determined target value for the torque, the input actual value for the output speed does not exceed the limit value established in the characteristic curve. In the step of outputting the control signal, said control signal can be output to at least one of the aforementioned components of the electric drivetrain in order to actuate them and bring about the operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain.

(14) Using embodiments of the present disclosure, a resulting output speed of the electric drivetrain can be monitored directly and action can be taken in the electric drivetrain on that basis in order to bring about an operationally safe state if the output speed is erroneous. Furthermore, embodiments of the present disclosure allow the resulting output speed itself to be limited and monitored as a response by the electric drivetrain to its actuation, in order to bring about the operationally safe state. Intrinsic safety of an electric drivetrain can thus be efficiently ensured. This is particularly advantageous if the electric drivetrain has direct drive.

(15) According to an embodiment of the method, as a further step it can comprise ascertaining an actual value of an output speed gradient of the self-propelled work machine on the basis of the input actual value for the output speed. The output speed gradient can be an output speed curve of the electric drivetrain. As a further step, the method can comprise inputting the output speed curve. The output speed curve can be an output speed curve of the electric motor, the transmission, or the wheel in the electric drivetrain. As a further step, the method can comprise acquiring the output speed curve using the speed sensor. The output speed curve can be read out from the speed sensor either directly or indirectly. The output speed curve can also be determined on the basis of at least two input output speeds.

(16) In accordance with the previous embodiment, a limit value for the output speed gradient of the self-propelled work machine can be established in the step of establishing the characteristic curve. The limit value for the output speed gradient can be established according to the input actual value for either the longitudinal tilt or a target value for the torque. The characteristic curve can thus define a maximum value for the output speed gradient. According to this embodiment, in the verification step, a verification can be carried out as to whether the ascertained actual value of the output speed gradient exceeds the limit value for the output speed gradient as established in the characteristic curve. A verification result based on the verification step can be that the ascertained actual value of the output gradient exceeds the limit value for the output speed gradient as established in the characteristic curve. A further verification result based on the verification step can be that the ascertained actual value of the output speed gradient does not exceed the limit value for the output speed gradient as established in the characteristic curve.

(17) In accordance with the previous embodiment, the step of outputting the control signal can be carried out if the verification result shows that the ascertained actual value of the output speed gradient exceeds the limit value for the output speed gradient as established in the characteristic curve. According to an embodiment, the step of outputting the control signal is not carried out if the verification result shows that the ascertained actual value of the output speed gradient does not exceed the limit value for the output speed gradient as established in the characteristic curve. According to this embodiment, the output speed gradient of the electrical actuation can be monitored efficiently.

(18) According to a further embodiment of the method, as a further step it can comprise ascertaining an actual value of a longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine on the basis of the input actual value for the output speed. The longitudinal jerk can be a gradient of the output speed gradient of the self-propelled work machine, and the output speed gradient can define a longitudinal acceleration of the self-propelled work machine.

(19) In accordance with the previous embodiment, a limit value for the longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine can be established in the step of establishing the characteristic curve. The limit value for the longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine can be established

according to the input actual value for either the longitudinal tilt or a target value for the torque. The characteristic curve can thus define a maximum value for the longitudinal jerk. According to this embodiment, in the verification step, a verification can be carried out as to whether the ascertained actual value of the longitudinal jerk exceeds the limit value for the longitudinal jerk as established in the characteristic curve. A verification result based on the verification step can be that the ascertained actual value of the longitudinal jerk exceeds the limit value for the longitudinal jerk as established in the characteristic curve. A further verification result based on the verification step can be that the ascertained actual value of the longitudinal jerk does not exceed the limit value for the longitudinal jerk as established in the characteristic curve.

(20) In accordance with the previous embodiment, the step of outputting the control signal can be carried out if the verification result shows that the ascertained actual value of the longitudinal jerk exceeds the limit value for the longitudinal jerk as established in the characteristic curve.

According to an embodiment, the step of outputting the control signal is not carried out if the verification result shows that the ascertained actual value of the longitudinal jerk does not exceed the limit value for the longitudinal jerk as established in the characteristic curve. According to this embodiment, the longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine can be monitored efficiently.

(21) According to a further embodiment of the method, as a further step it comprises determining a target value for a torque of the electric drivetrain. The target value for the torque can be a corresponding target value specified to the electric motor by a controller. Alternatively or additionally, the target value for the torque can be a corresponding target value specified to the transmission by a transmission controller. The torque of the electric drivetrain can comprise at least one out of a driving torque of the electric drivetrain and an output torque of the electric drivetrain. The driving torque and the output torque can each be a corresponding torque of one of the aforementioned components of the electric drivetrain. According to this embodiment of the method, the step of establishing the characteristic curve can be carried out as a function of the torque. The target value for the torque can be provided by the controller in order for said target value to be output to the electric motor, an inverter, or power electronics in the electric drivetrain. The target value for the torque can be communicated to the electric drivetrain by the controller according to a driver request. The target value for the torque can be provided by the transmission controller in order for said target value to be output to the transmission, an inverter, or power electronics in the electric drivetrain. The target value for the torque can be communicated to the electric drivetrain by the transmission controller according to a driver request.

(22) According to a further embodiment of the method, as a further step it can comprise inputting a driver request for the electric drivetrain to longitudinally drive the self-propelled work machine. The driver request can comprise at least one out of a gas pedal position for accelerating or decelerating the self-propelled work machine, a brake pedal position for braking the self-propelled work machine, and a switch position of a driving direction switch for adjusting a driving direction of the self-propelled work machine. According to this embodiment, the step of determining the target value for the torque can be carried out on the basis of the input driver request. The target value can be determined according to the input driver request.

(23) According to a further embodiment of the method, as a further step it can comprise inputting a driver request for the electric drivetrain to longitudinally drive the self-propelled work machine. According to this embodiment, the step of establishing the characteristic curve can be carried out as a function of the input driver request. Thus, the limit value for the output speed can be established or varied according to the input driver request. The limit value for the output speed can be established or varied proportionally to the input driver request. The verification step can also be carried out according to the input driver request. As a further step, the method can comprise verifying whether the input driver request exceeds a predetermined limit value for the driver request. The step of outputting the control signal can be carried out according to a verification result based on the verification step.

- (24) According to a further embodiment of the method, the step of establishing the characteristic curve can be carried out as a function of the input actual value for the output speed. Thus, the limit value for the output speed can also be established or varied according to the input actual value for the output speed. The verification step can therefore be carried out according to the input actual value for the output speed.
- (25) According to a further embodiment of the method, as a further step it can comprise debouncing or filtering the input actual value for the output speed. According to this embodiment, in the verification step, a verification can be carried out as to whether the debounced or filtered actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. The verification step can thus be carried out even more reliably.
- (26) According to a further embodiment of the method, as a further step it can comprise determining whether the self-propelled work machine is in a stationary state. According to this embodiment, the step of outputting the control signal can be carried out if the self-propelled work machine is in a stationary state. According to this embodiment, at least one further step of the method can be carried out if the self-propelled work machine is in a stationary state. Thus, the self-propelled work machine can be driven out of a stationary state in a safe operating state of the self-propelled work machine. In this way, undesirable acceleration of the self-propelled work machine out of the stationary state can be avoided.
- (27) According to a further embodiment of the method, in the step of outputting the control signal, a control signal for deactivating at least one drive component in the electric drivetrain can be output for bringing about the operationally safe state according to the verification result based on the verification step. According to an embodiment, the control signal is output to the inverter of the electric drivetrain. The control signal can be configured to switch at least one component of the electric drivetrain to a zero-torque state via the inverter. Thus, the operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain can be efficiently brought about.
- (28) In a further aspect, the present disclosure relates to a control device for monitoring an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine. The control device can be configured to carry out the method according to the preceding aspect. The control device can comprise corresponding units and interfaces that are configured to carry out the steps of the method.
- (29) The control device comprises a unit for inputting an actual value for a longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine. The control device can comprise a unit for determining a target value for a torque of the electric drivetrain. The control device comprises an interface for inputting an actual value for the output speed. The control device comprises a unit for establishing a characteristic curve of a limit value for the output speed as a function of the longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine. The unit can be configured to establish the characteristic curve as a function of the torque. The control device comprises a unit for verifying whether, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. The unit can be configured to verify whether, according to the determined target value for the torque, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. Furthermore, the control device comprises an interface for outputting a control signal for bringing about an operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain according to a verification result based on the verification. According to an embodiment, the control device can be one of the controllers according to the preceding aspect.
- (30) In a further aspect, the present disclosure relates to a self-propelled work machine. The self-propelled work machine can be a work machine described in relation to the preceding aspects. The self-propelled work machine comprises an electric drivetrain. In addition, the self-propelled work machine comprises a control device according to the preceding aspect for monitoring an output speed of the electric drivetrain.
- (31) Embodiments and features of one aspect of the present disclosure can constitute corresponding

embodiments and features of a further aspect of the present disclosure.

(32) FIG. 1 schematically shows a self-propelled work machine **100**. The self-propelled work machine **100** comprises an electric drivetrain **10** and a control device **20**. The control device **20** is configured to monitor an output speed of the electric drivetrain **10**. For this purpose, the control device **20** is configured to carry out the method steps shown in FIG. 2. The control device **20** and the electric drivetrain **10** are interconnected by means of respective interfaces. The control device **20** is configured to monitor the output speed of at least one component of the electric drivetrain **10**. According to an embodiment, the component is an electric motor of the electric drivetrain **10**.

(33) FIG. 2 is a flowchart comprising method steps for carrying out a method for monitoring the output speed of the electric drivetrain **10** of the self-propelled work machine **100** using the control device **20**. The method steps are shown in sequential order according to an embodiment of the method.

(34) In a first step **S0** of the method, a stationary state of the self-propelled work machine **100** is determined. According to an embodiment of the method, the further steps of the method are carried out if it has been determined that the self-propelled work machine **100** is in a stationary state. In a further step **S1** of the method, a driver request is input. According to an embodiment of the method, the driver request is input from a gas pedal that a driver can operate. In a further step **S2** of the method, a target value for a torque of the electric drivetrain **10** is determined. The target value for the torque is determined on the basis of the input driver request.

(35) In a further step **S3** of the method, an actual value based on the output speed is input from the electric drivetrain **10**. In a sub-step **S3a**, an actual value for the output speed is input. In a further sub-step **S3b**, an actual value of a longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine **100** is input. In a further optional sub-step **S3c**, a driver request for the self-propelled work machine **100** to be longitudinally driven is input. In a first step **S4** of the method, an actual value dependent on the output speed is ascertained. In a further sub-step **S4a**, an actual value of an output speed gradient of the self-propelled work machine **100** is ascertained. In a further sub-step **S4b**, an actual value of a longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine **100** is ascertained. The ascertaining sub-steps **S4a**, **S4b** are based on at least one actual value input during the step.

(36) In a further step **S5** of the method, a characteristic curve of a limit value for the output speed is established as a function of the determined target value for the torque. According to a relevant embodiment, in the step of establishing the characteristic curve, a limit value for the output speed gradient and a limit value for the longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine **100** are established.

(37) In a further step **S6** of the method, a verification is carried out as to whether, according to the determined target value for the torque, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve. If a verification result **P** of the verification step shows that the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve, a control signal is output in a further step **S7** of the method. The control signal is output for bringing about an operationally safe state of the electric drivetrain **10**. According to an embodiment, at least one component of the electric drivetrain **10** is switched off in order to bring about the operationally safe state.

(38) While subject matter of the present disclosure has been illustrated and described in detail in the drawings and foregoing description, such illustration and description are to be considered illustrative or exemplary and not restrictive. Any statement made herein characterizing the invention is also to be considered illustrative or exemplary and not restrictive as the invention is defined by the claims. It will be understood that changes and modifications may be made, by those of ordinary skill in the art, within the scope of the following claims, which may include any combination of features from different embodiments described above.

(39) The terms used in the claims should be construed to have the broadest reasonable interpretation consistent with the foregoing description. For example, the use of the article “a” or

“the” in introducing an element should not be interpreted as being exclusive of a plurality of elements. Likewise, the recitation of “or” should be interpreted as being inclusive, such that the recitation of “A or B” is not exclusive of “A and B,” unless it is clear from the context or the foregoing description that only one of A and B is intended. Further, the recitation of “at least one of A, B and C” should be interpreted as one or more of a group of elements consisting of A, B and C, and should not be interpreted as requiring at least one of each of the listed elements A, B and C, regardless of whether A, B and C are related as categories or otherwise. Moreover, the recitation of “A, B and/or C” or “at least one of A, B or C” should be interpreted as including any singular entity from the listed elements, e.g., A, any subset from the listed elements, e.g., A and B, or the entire list of elements A, B and C.

REFERENCE SIGNS

(40) **10** Electric drivetrain **20** Control device **100** Self-propelled work machine **P** Verification result
S0 Determining a stationary state **S1** Inputting a driver request **S2** Determining a target value **S3**
Inputting an actual value **S3a** Inputting an actual value of an output speed **S3b** Inputting an actual
value of a longitudinal tilt **S3c** Inputting a driver request **S4** Ascertaining actual value **S4a**
Ascertaining an actual value of an output speed gradient **S4b** Ascertaining an actual value of a
longitudinal jerk **S5** Establishing a characteristic curve **S6** Verifying an actual value of an output
speed **S7** Outputting a control signal

Claims

1. A method for controlling an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine, comprising: inputting an actual value for a longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine; inputting an actual value for the output speed; establishing a characteristic curve of a limit value for the output speed as a function of the longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine; verifying whether, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve; and operating an electric drivetrain by outputting a control signal configured to operate the electric drivetrain according to a verification result based on the verification step.
2. The method according to claim 1, further comprising ascertaining an actual value of an output speed gradient of the self-propelled work machine on based on the input actual value for the output speed, a limit value for the output speed gradient of the self-propelled work machine being established in the step of establishing the characteristic curve, and a verification being carried out in the verification step as to whether the ascertained actual value of the output speed gradient exceeds the limit value for the output speed gradient as established in the characteristic curve.
3. The method according to claim 1, further comprising ascertaining an actual value of a longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine based on the input actual value for the output speed, a limit value for the longitudinal jerk of the self-propelled work machine being established in the step of establishing the characteristic curve, and a verification being carried out in the verification step as to whether the ascertained actual value of the longitudinal jerk exceeds the limit value for the longitudinal jerk as established in the characteristic curve.
4. The method according to claim 1, further comprising determining a target value for a torque of the electric drivetrain, the step of establishing the characteristic curve being carried out as a function of the torque.
5. The method according to claim 4, further comprising inputting a driver request for the electric drivetrain to drive the self-propelled work machine longitudinally, the step of determining the target value for the torque being carried out based on the input driver request.
6. The method according to claim 1, further comprising inputting a driver request for the electric drivetrain to drive the self-propelled work machine longitudinally, the step of establishing the characteristic curve being carried out as a function of the input driver request.

7. The method according to claim 1, wherein the step of establishing the characteristic curve is carried out as a function of the input actual value for the output speed.
 8. The method according to claim 1, further comprising debouncing the input actual value for the output speed, a verification being carried out in the verification step as to whether the debounced actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve.
 9. The method according to claim 1, further comprising determining whether the self-propelled work machine is in a stationary state, the step of outputting the control signal being carried out if the self-propelled work machine is in a stationary state.
 10. The method according to claim 1, wherein in the step of outputting the control signal, a control signal for deactivating at least one drive component in the electric drivetrain is output for bringing about the operationally safe state according to the verification result based on the verification step.
 11. A control device for controlling an output speed of an electric drivetrain of a self-propelled work machine, comprising: an input unit for inputting an actual value for a longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine; an interface for inputting an actual value for the output speed; an establishing unit for establishing a characteristic curve of a limit value for the output speed as a function of the longitudinal tilt of the self-propelled work machine; a verifying unit for verifying whether, according to the input actual value for the longitudinal tilt, the input actual value for the output speed exceeds the limit value established in the characteristic curve; and an interface configured to control the electric drivetrain by outputting a control signal configured to operate the electric drivetrain according to a verification result based on the verification.
 12. A self-propelled work machine comprising: an electric drivetrain; and the control device according to claim 11 for monitoring an output speed of the electric drivetrain.
-